Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Major Projects
Toronto Transit Commission

Re: Senior Project Engineer, Waterfront East Rapid Transit Line (Requisition 13718)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Project Engineer position on the Waterfront East Rapid Transit Line. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, with a master's degree in transportation engineering. The part of the posting I can speak to is the coordination: keeping several parties working from the same information and moving toward the same decision.

At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations. I plan the work, hold the schedule, and report progress to the people relying on it, while working with other divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities do not always line up. I review development applications and the studies filed with them, and I write the briefing notes and presentations that put issues and options in front of senior staff. Earlier, at Metrolinx, I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed changes would do to run times and reliability before they were taken forward, and at Mott MacDonald I worked on Ontario Line construction staging.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not delivered a major capital project from design through construction, and I have not managed a project budget, a formal risk register or a critical path schedule. The posting asks for five years of delivering complex infrastructure projects, and my experience is shorter than that and closer to planning and analysis than to delivery. I do not hold a P.Eng. I am applying because the coordination, reporting and stakeholder work is close to what I already do, and a transit expansion on the waterfront is work I would like to contribute to.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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